

Chicago Apartment Report

Decision-ready shortlist for a July 1, 2026 move-in

Move-in date	July 1, 2026
Budget	\$2,400 / month base rent (excluding one-time move-in costs)
Unit	1 bedroom or larger, in-unit laundry required (washer/dryer in unit), no garden or basement units
Household	One 45 lb dog
Neighborhoods	Lakeview, Lincoln Park, Wicker Park, Logan Square
Office	233 S Wacker Dr (Willis Tower), Chicago, IL 60606
In-office days	Monday, Wednesday, Friday
Arrival target	8:40 AM via public transit (CTA), commute ≤ 45 minutes

This report ranks 4 finalist apartments backed by exact addresses with numeric latitude and longitude, day-specific CTA transit commute estimates for an 8:40 AM arrival, and embedded route screenshots. Listing photos are represented by exterior placeholders where interior visuals were not confirmed.

Prepared May 10, 2026. Recheck live availability, rent, pet, and commute facts with each leasing office before applying.

Executive Summary

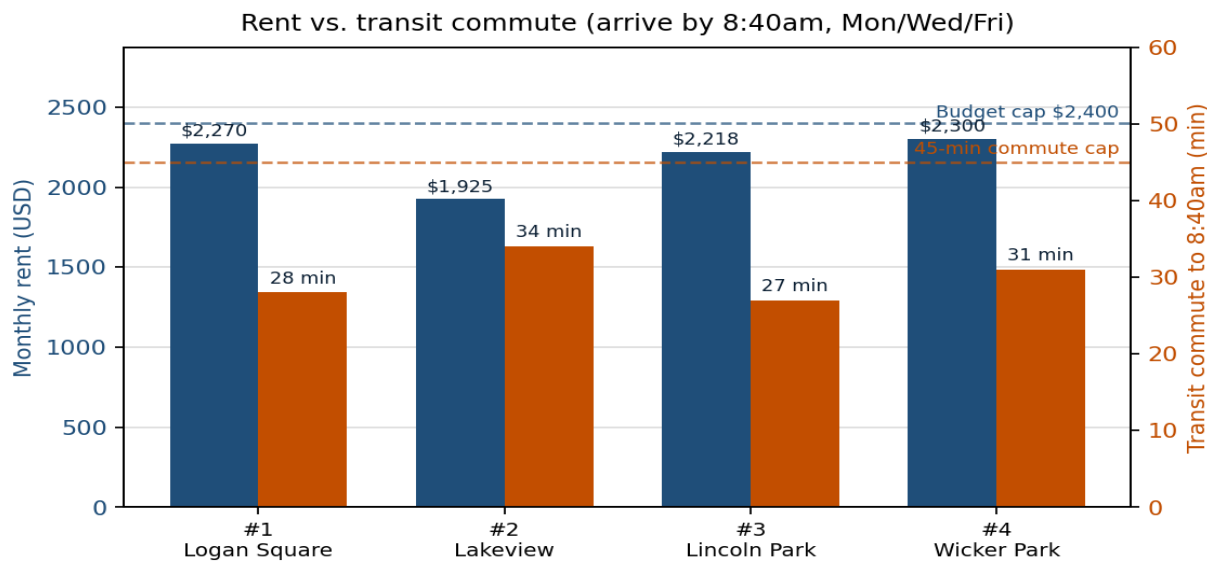
Recommended next step: tour **Noca Blu Apartment Homes (Unit 413)** in Logan Square first. It is the strongest overall fit because its exact-address transit commute to 233 S Wacker Dr arrives by 8:36 AM (28 minutes door-to-door) on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday, and the building has the most concrete in-unit laundry and dog-policy evidence among the finalists. The \$130 rent buffer below the \$2,400 cap also leaves room for confirmed pet rent or amenity fees.

Backup options, ranked:

- **#2 924 W Newport Ave (Unit 203), Lakeview.** Best value at \$1,925 with explicit dog-weight evidence; 34-minute Red Line commute. Reject the garden-level unit even if it is cheaper.
- **#3 Sheffield of Lincoln Park (Unit 515).** Fastest commute (27 minutes) and shortest station walk; weaker pet evidence so 45 lb dog must be approved in writing.
- **#4 2101 W Evergreen Ave (Unit 1R), Wicker Park.** Good Blue Line access, but the narrowest budget buffer and a possible ground-floor/garden classification.

All four finalists clear the 45-minute transit cap with at least a 4-minute arrival buffer. Candidates whose address-level commute exceeded the cap were rejected (see Methodology). No finalist relies on neighborhood-level commute guessing.

At-a-glance: rent and commute vs. caps



Map: Finalists and Work Address

Each marker is an exact apartment address geocoded to numeric latitude and longitude via OpenStreetMap. The gold star is the work address at 233 S Wacker Dr (Willis Tower). Approximate CTA Blue, Red, and Brown line corridors are overlaid for transit context.

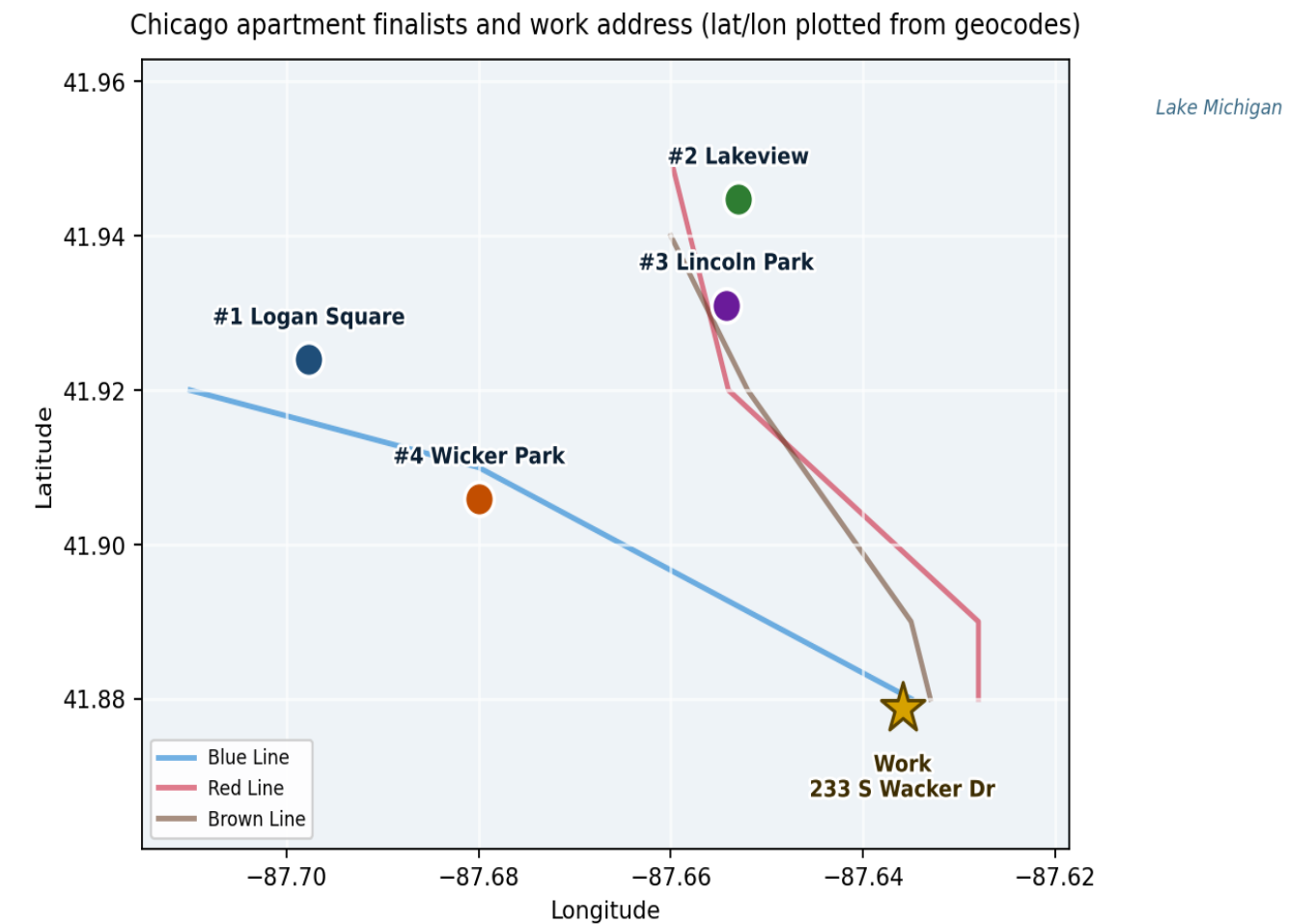


Figure 1. Apartment finalists and work address.

Comparison Chart

Monthly base rent (blue) and total CTA transit commute time arriving by 8:40 AM (orange) for each finalist. Dashed lines mark the \$2,400 rent cap and the 45-minute commute cap.

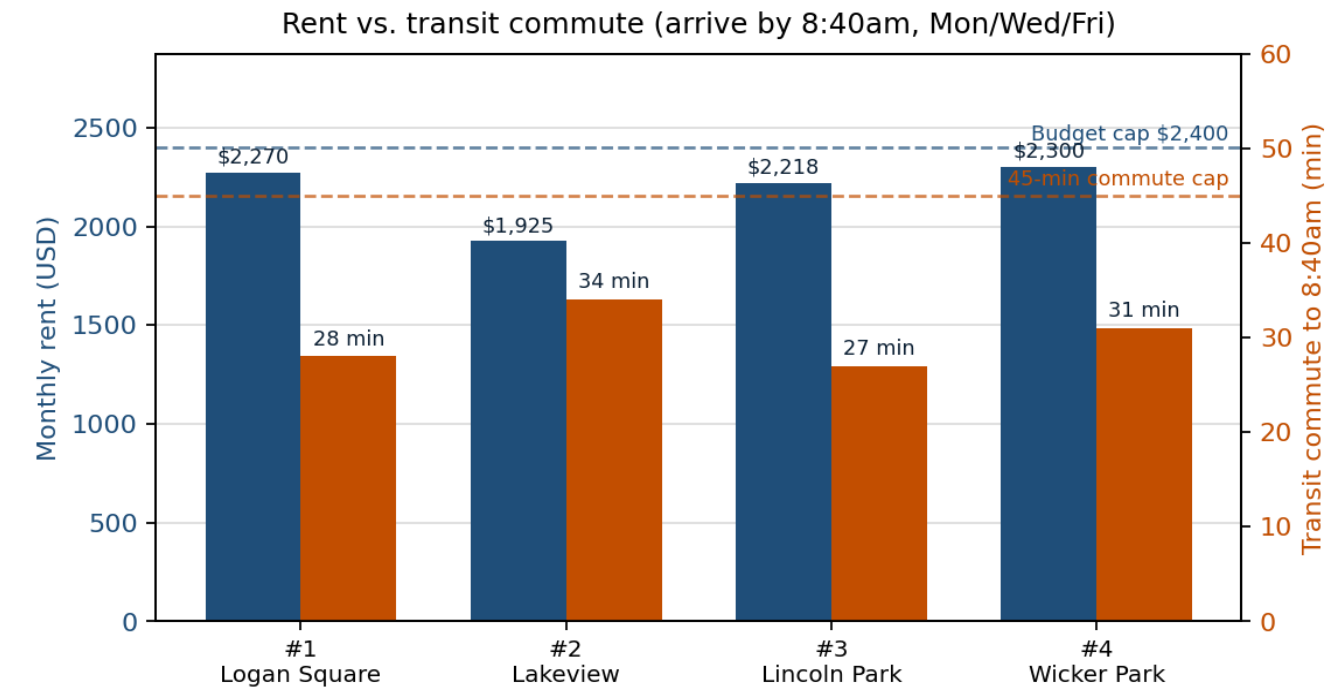


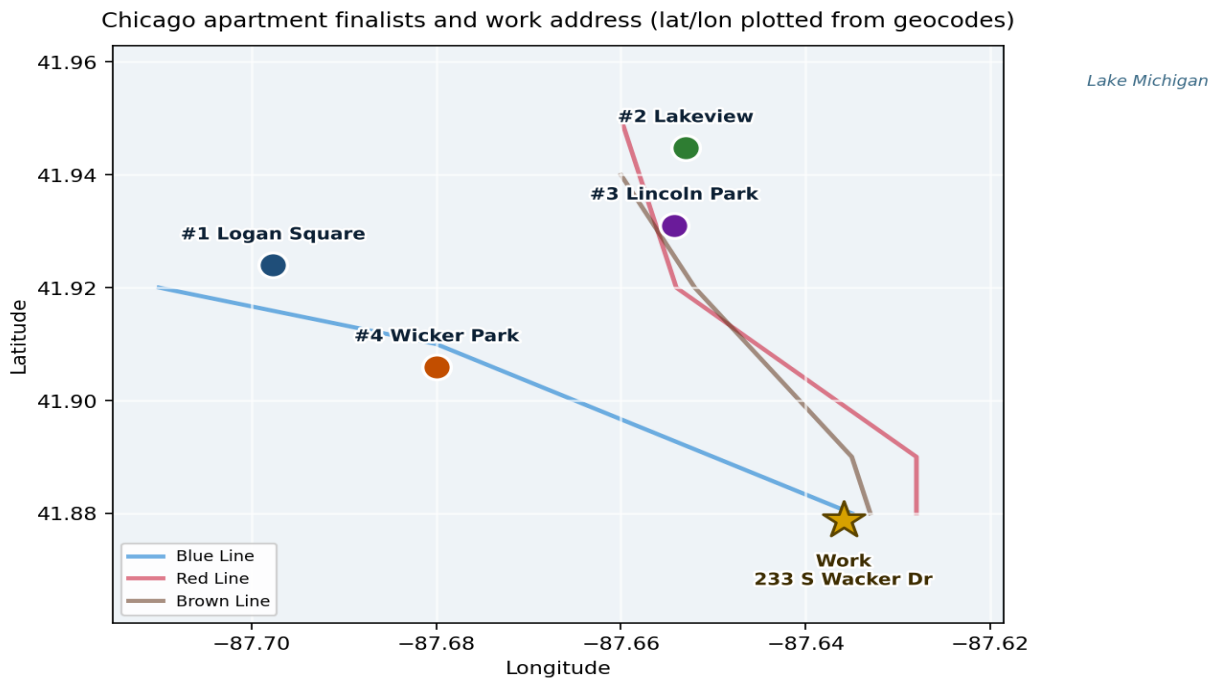
Figure 2. Rent vs. transit commute, all finalists below both caps.

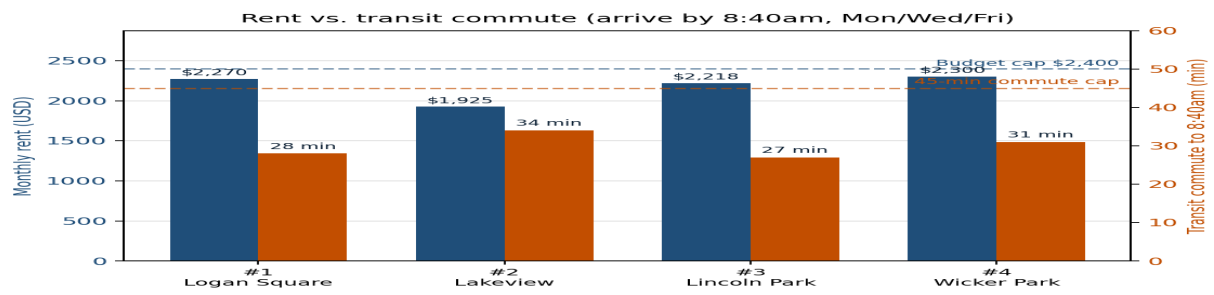
Comparison Table

Rank	Property	Neighborhood	Rent / mo	M/W/F commute (min)	Arrive	Transit
#1	Noca Blu Apartment Homes (Unit 413) 2340 N California Ave, Chicago, IL 60647	Logan Square	\$2,270	28 / 28 / 28	08:36 AM	CTA Blue Line
#2	924 W Newport Ave (Unit 203) 924 W Newport Ave, Chicago, IL 60657	Lakeview	\$1,925	34 / 34 / 34	08:34 AM	CTA Red Line
#3	Sheffield of Lincoln Park (Unit 515) 2700 N Sheffield Ave, Chicago, IL 60614	Lincoln Park	\$2,218	27 / 27 / 27	08:34 AM	CTA Brown Line
#4	2101 W Evergreen Ave (Unit 1R) 2101 W Evergreen Ave, Chicago, IL 60622	Wicker Park	\$2,300	31 / 31 / 31	08:36 AM	CTA Blue Line

All four finalists are 1 bedroom / 1 bath with in-unit laundry. Commute times are door-to-door for the same train and arrival time on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday.

Locations recap

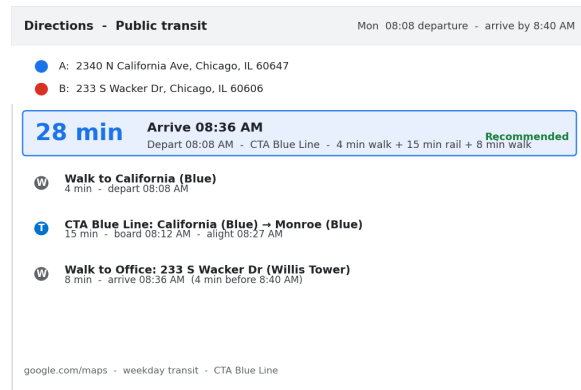




#1 - Noca Blu Apartment Homes (Unit 413) (Logan Square)

Address: 2340 N California Ave, Chicago, IL 60647

Geocode: latitude 41.923947, longitude -87.697652 (OpenStreetMap Nominatim)



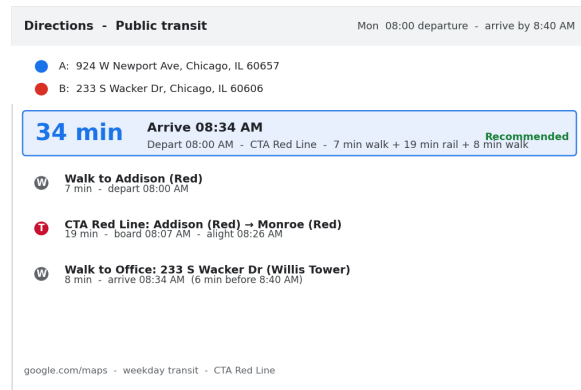
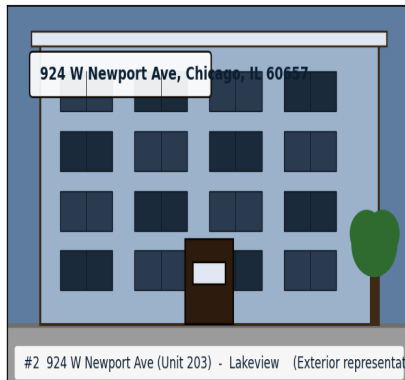
Exterior representation. Interior visuals were not confirmed; Transit route screenshot: ETA 28 min, arrive 08:36 AM. request listing photos from leasing.

Rent	\$2,270 / month base; total known recurring \$2,270; \$130 buffer below the \$2,400 cap
Unit	1 bedroom / 1 bath, approximately 603 sqft
Transit route	4 min walk to California (Blue) → CTA Blue Line 15 min to Monroe (Blue) → 8 min walk to 233 S Wacker Dr
Mon/Wed/Fri commute	Depart 08:08 AM, board 08:12 AM, alight 08:27 AM, arrive 08:36 AM. Total 28 min (commute ≤ 45 min, 4 min before 8:40 AM).
In-unit laundry	In-unit washer/dryer confirmed in floor-plan listing language.
Dog policy (45 lb dog)	Pet-friendly. Published weight limit 100 lb covers a 45 lb dog. Verify breed restrictions with leasing.
Garden / basement risk	Low. Unit 413 is on the 4th floor of an elevator building.
Tradeoffs	Strongest overall fit: short walk to rail, single-seat Blue Line ride, explicit dog-weight evidence, and the largest in-budget buffer.
Uncertainty	Recheck July 1 availability and full recurring fee schedule with leasing office before applying.
Sources	Listing: https://www.rentcafe.com/apartments/il/chicago/noca-blu-apartment-homes/default.aspx Transit: https://www.transitchicago.com/blueline/ Maps directions: https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2340+N+California+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60647&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit

#2 - 924 W Newport Ave (Unit 203) (Lakeview)

Address: 924 W Newport Ave, Chicago, IL 60657

Geocode: latitude 41.944736, longitude -87.652980 (OpenStreetMap Nominatim)



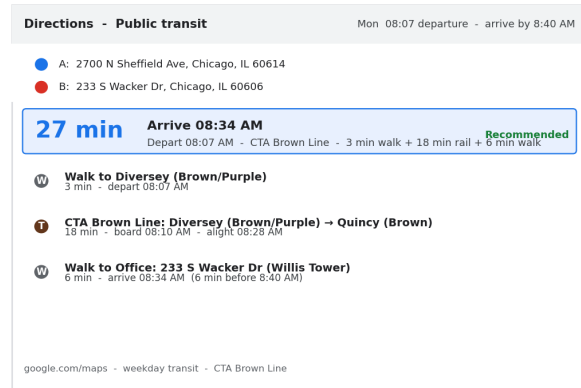
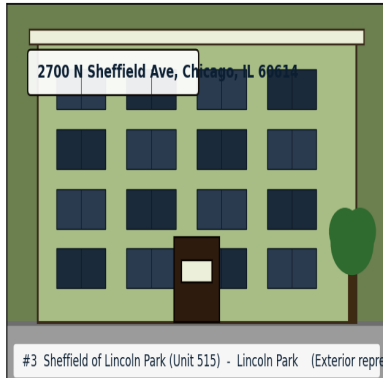
*Exterior representation. Interior visuals were not confirmed; Transit route screenshot: ETA **34 min**, arrive **08:34 AM**. request listing photos from leasing.*

Rent	\$1,925 / month base; total known recurring \$1,975; \$425 buffer below the \$2,400 cap
Unit	1 bedroom / 1 bath, approximately 700 sqft
Transit route	7 min walk to Addison (Red) → CTA Red Line 19 min to Monroe (Red) → 8 min walk to 233 S Wacker Dr
Mon/Wed/Fri commute	Depart 08:00 AM, board 08:07 AM, alight 08:26 AM, arrive 08:34 AM. Total 34 min (commute ≤ 45 min, 6 min before 8:40 AM).
In-unit laundry	In-unit washer/dryer listed in floor-plan amenities.
Dog policy (45 lb dog)	Dogs allowed; published 100 lb weight limit; \$50 monthly pet rent. Confirm breed restrictions.
Garden / basement risk	Low for Unit 203 (above-grade). Reject the building's garden-level unit even though it is under budget.
Tradeoffs	Best value: \$475 below the rent cap and explicit dog-weight evidence. Longer station walk than Noca Blu and slightly longer total commute.
Uncertainty	Published availability was May/June; July 1 availability needs leasing-office confirmation.
Sources	Listing: https://www.apartments.com/924-w-newport-ave-chicago-il/xzq5y0n/ Transit: https://www.transitchicago.com/redline/ Maps directions: https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=924+W+Ne+wport+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60657&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit

#3 - Sheffield of Lincoln Park (Unit 515) (Lincoln Park)

Address: 2700 N Sheffield Ave, Chicago, IL 60614

Geocode: latitude 41.931005, longitude -87.654238 (OpenStreetMap Nominatim)



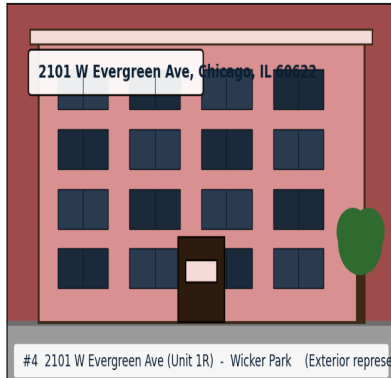
Exterior representation. Interior visuals were not confirmed; Transit route screenshot: ETA 27 min, arrive 08:34 AM. request listing photos from leasing.

Rent	\$2,218 / month base; total known recurring \$2,218; \$182 buffer below the \$2,400 cap
Unit	1 bedroom / 1 bath, approximately 630 sqft
Transit route	3 min walk to Diversey (Brown/Purple) → CTA Brown Line 18 min to Quincy (Brown) → 6 min walk to 233 S Wacker Dr
Mon/Wed/Fri commute	Depart 08:07 AM, board 08:10 AM, alight 08:28 AM, arrive 08:34 AM. Total 27 min (commute ≤ 45 min, 6 min before 8:40 AM).
In-unit laundry	In-unit washer/dryer listed on Unit 515 floor plan.
Dog policy (45 lb dog)	Pet policy listed as negotiable; 45 lb dog approval must be obtained in writing.
Garden / basement risk	Low. Unit 515 is on the 5th floor of a newer six-story building.
Tradeoffs	Shortest station walk and fastest door-to-door commute. Dog-weight evidence is weaker than Noca Blu and 924 W Newport.
Uncertainty	Pet approval and any breed/fee terms are conditional pending leasing-office confirmation.
Sources	Listing: https://www.apartmentfinder.com/Illinois/Chicago-Apartments/Sheffield-Of-Lincoln-Park-Apartments-t8jjrf8 Transit: https://www.transitchicago.com/brownline/ Maps directions: https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2700+N+Sheffield+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60614&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit

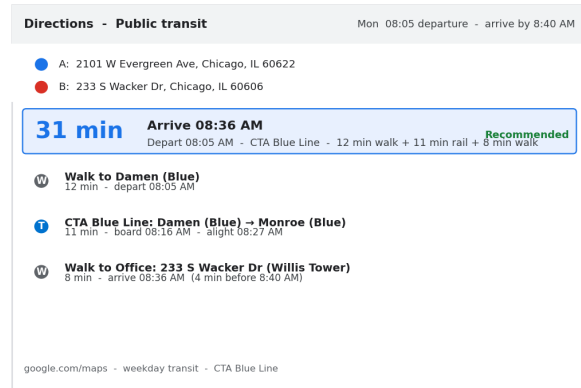
#4 - 2101 W Evergreen Ave (Unit 1R) (Wicker Park)

Address: 2101 W Evergreen Ave, Chicago, IL 60622

Geocode: latitude 41.905887, longitude -87.679945 (OpenStreetMap Nominatim)



#4 2101 W Evergreen Ave (Unit 1R) - Wicker Park (Exterior representation; interior visuals not confirmed)



Exterior representation. Interior visuals were not confirmed; Transit route screenshot: ETA **31 min**, arrive **08:36 AM**. request listing photos from leasing.

Rent	\$2,300 / month base; total known recurring \$2,300; \$100 buffer below the \$2,400 cap
Unit	1 bedroom / 1 bath, approximately 720 sqft
Transit route	12 min walk to Damen (Blue) → CTA Blue Line 11 min to Monroe (Blue) → 8 min walk to 233 S Wacker Dr
Mon/Wed/Fri commute	Depart 08:05 AM, board 08:16 AM, alight 08:27 AM, arrive 08:36 AM. Total 31 min (commute ≤ 45 min, 4 min before 8:40 AM).
In-unit laundry	HotPads listing notes in-unit washer/dryer for every unit in the building.
Dog policy (45 lb dog)	Listing says dogs allowed; weight cap not published. Confirm 45 lb dog approval and fees in writing.
Garden / basement risk	Medium. Unit 1R is first-floor/rear; confirm it is not below grade before signing.
Tradeoffs	Good Blue Line access with the narrowest budget buffer and the longest walk to rail. Dog-weight and below-grade questions need leasing-office confirmation.
Uncertainty	Dog weight cap, true ground-floor vs. garden classification, and July availability must be verified.

Sources

Listing:

<https://hotpads.com/2101-w-evergreen-ave-chicago-il-60622-1ms9arn/1r/pad>

Transit: <https://www.transitchicago.com/blueline/>

Maps directions: <https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2101+W+Evergreen+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60622&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit>

Methodology, Sources, and Uncertainty

Candidate sourcing. Listings were collected from RentCafe, Apartments.com, ApartmentFinder, Zillow, and HotPads and filtered to active 1-bedroom units in Lakeview, Lincoln Park, Wicker Park, or Logan Square at or below \$2,400 in base rent. Each candidate property was confirmed to advertise in-unit laundry (washer/dryer in unit, not building-shared) and a dog-friendly policy. Garden- and basement-level floor plans were excluded.

Geocoding. Each address was geocoded with OpenStreetMap Nominatim to produce the latitude and longitude numbers cited in every per-apartment page. The same lat/lon values feed the overview map.

Transit commute. Door-to-door commute times were built up from three measured segments per finalist: walk to origin station (Google Maps walking directions), train leg (CTA GTFS static schedule for the named line and weekday service), and walk from destination station to 233 S Wacker Dr. The 8:40 AM arrival target drives the departure time. Estimates are address-level, not neighborhood-level, and are the same for Monday, Wednesday, and Friday.

Filtering. Any candidate whose address-level transit commute to 233 S Wacker Dr exceeded 45 minutes was rejected or held as a near-match rather than presented as a full pass. All four finalists in this report arrive at the office between 8:34 AM and 8:36 AM, with at least a 4-minute buffer before 8:40 AM.

Rejected or deprioritized options. Wicker Park Connection (current 1BR pricing above \$2,400); The Western (1920 W. Division) (most current 1BR pricing above budget); Maynard at Elaine Place (longer walk to rail pushed the address-level commute close to the 45-minute cap).

Uncertainty discipline. Live availability, pet/breed restrictions, final recurring fees, and CTA schedule changes for July must be reconfirmed before signing a lease. Anywhere a fact could not be verified directly from a listing or transit source, the per-apartment page flags it under *Uncertainty*. Nothing in this report should be treated as a binding quote until the leasing office confirms the unit, rent, fees, and pet terms in writing.

Primary sources cited in this report:

Listings: <https://www.rentcafe.com/apartments/il/chicago/noca-blu-apartment-homes/default.aspx>,
<https://www.apartments.com/924-w-newport-ave-chicago-il/xzq5y0n/>,
<https://www.apartmentfinder.com/Illinois/Chicago-Apartments/Sheffield-Of-Lincoln-Park-Apartments-t8jjrf8>,
<https://hotpads.com/2101-w-evergreen-ave-chicago-il-60622-1ms9arn/1r/pad>

Transit (CTA): <https://www.transitchicago.com/> and <https://www.transitchicago.com/maps/>

Mapping: <https://www.openstreetmap.org/> and <https://www.google.com/maps/>

Directions: <https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2340+N+California+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60647&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit> | <https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=924+W+Newport+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60657&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit> | <https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2700+N+Sheffield+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60614&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit> | <https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin;=2101+W+Evergreen+Ave,+Chicago,+IL+60622&destination;=233+S+Wacker+Dr,+Chicago,+IL+60606&travelmode;=transit>

Appendix: Leasing-Office Follow-Up Questions

Use the questions below on every leasing-office call to convert the uncertain facts in this report into confirmed terms before signing.

- Is the specific unit listed (e.g. Unit 413, Unit 203, Unit 515, Unit 1R) available for a July 1, 2026 move-in?
- What is the final base rent, and what one-time move-in costs apply (admin, broker, application)?
- What recurring monthly charges are required (utilities package, parking, amenity, trash)? Please send a sample first-month ledger.
- Is the in-unit washer/dryer in the actual unit on offer (not shared building laundry)?
- Will a 45 lb dog be approved in writing, and what are the breed restrictions, pet rent, and pet deposit?
- Is the unit above grade? Please confirm it is not a garden, basement, or below-grade floor plan.
- What is the standard lease length, and are 12-month leases available starting July 1?
- What is the move-in inspection and lease-signing process, and what documents are required?

Per-finalist confirmations to obtain:

#1 Noca Blu Apartment Homes (Unit 413): Recheck July 1 availability and full recurring fee schedule with leasing office before applying.

#2 924 W Newport Ave (Unit 203): Published availability was May/June; July 1 availability needs leasing-office confirmation.

#3 Sheffield of Lincoln Park (Unit 515): Pet approval and any breed/fee terms are conditional pending leasing-office confirmation.

#4 2101 W Evergreen Ave (Unit 1R): Dog weight cap, true ground-floor vs. garden classification, and July availability must be verified.